

Northwind Systems Employee Handbook

Welcome and scope

This handbook applies to all Northwind Systems employees in the United States, including full-time, part-time, and fixed-term staff. Contractors are covered by their agency agreement and by the Code of Conduct, but not by the benefits described here.

Where this handbook conflicts with a specific policy document, the specific policy document takes precedence.

Working hours

Standard working hours are 40 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in your local time zone, during which you are expected to be reachable. Outside core hours you may arrange your schedule as you and your manager agree.

Non-exempt employees must record actual hours worked in Workday by 17:00 on the last business day of each week. Overtime requires written manager approval before the hours are worked.

Probation period

New employees serve a probation period of 90 calendar days. During probation, either party may end employment with two weeks of notice. Probation may be extended once, by up to 60 days, with written notice before the original period ends.

Pay dates

Salaried employees are paid on the 15th and the last business day of each month. If a pay date falls on a weekend or public holiday, payment is made on the preceding business day.

Job levels

Northwind uses job levels L1 through L8. L1 to L3 are individual contributor roles, L4 and L5 are senior individual contributor or team lead roles, and L6 and above are management or principal roles. Level definitions are published in the internal career framework. Salary ranges attached to each level are not published in this handbook.

Notice periods

Employees at L1 to L3 give four weeks of notice when resigning. L4 and L5 give six weeks. L6 and above give twelve weeks. Northwind may agree to a shorter period in writing.

Changes to this handbook

People Operations reviews this handbook annually. Material changes are announced at least 30 days before they take effect. The version number on the cover page is the authoritative version.